California Driver-Education Video Validation and Curriculum Package

Prepared for: Lane app supplemental California driver education
Primary authority: California Quick Reference Driver’ s Handbook (DL 600X, 2025)
Scope: 19 supplied YouTube lessons, four supplemental-topic candidates, California accuracy edits, learner quizzes, optional decision-based QTE briefs, and locally bounded Novato-area impact framing.

Executive Finding

The review analyzed all **19 supplied videos** and identified **4 supplemental lessons** for material gaps. 18 supplied clips can be retained only with California-specific text or instruction; **1 supplied clip is not appropriate as an unmodified California lesson**. The curriculum preserves that clip as an explicitly localized example rather than relying on a learner to infer the traffic-side conversion. Each lesson therefore includes a California correction, a linked video reference, a low-stakes knowledge check, and a decision-only QTE brief where it adds instructional value.

> **Rights and delivery boundary.** Every reviewed YouTube item had an **unverified** Creative Commons/reuse status. The package therefore uses clickable source links and does not download, screen-record, re-upload, or embed third-party video media. A public YouTube page does not grant reuse rights. Obtain the creator’ s written permission or a clearly applicable license before copying media into an app, deck, or cloud presentation.

> **California authority boundary.** The supplied handbook is a quick-reference guide. It is the curriculum’ s controlling source for learner-facing rules. Where a clip conflicts with or omits California context, the California correction in this package controls. Current statute, DMV material, and local signs remain authoritative for live driving decisions.

How the Lesson Cards Are Structured

Each lesson card in the companion deck uses the same compact format: a color-coded category; a learner-facing title and caption; a linked source video; a concise California correction; a locally bounded impact statement; and a QTE asterisk when a non-crash decision prompt is worthwhile. One quiz card follows every lesson. The cards preserve the simple scrolling lesson-to-question rhythm requested for the app concept.

Of the 23 total lesson cards, **20** include a recommended decision-only QTE. These prompts ask a learner to choose a lawful, safe next step and give corrective feedback. They are

deliberately not crash simulations, impairment simulations, or time-pressure driving controls.

Local Impact Evidence: Use With the Stated Scope

An exhaustive, publicly defensible list of every Novato-area collision is not available from one complete public source. The strongest deck-ready evidence is a layered set: California Office of Traffic Safety (OTS) annual city/county fatal-and-injury profiles; Caltrans' annual state-highway-only county table; a narrowly bounded Transportation Authority of Marin (TAM) US 101 interchange study; and the County' s historical local-road safety plan. Treat their scopes as non-interchangeable. The recommended way to obtain a current custom extract is CHP/SWITRS through UC Berkeley SafeTREC' s Transportation Injury Mapping System (TIMS), using final years when possible and explicitly documenting geography, date range, severity, roadway jurisdiction, and whether counts are crashes or victims.

Evidence item	Verified scope and implication
California Office of Traffic Safety, Novato 2023	incorporated-city profile for Novato, Marin County, calendar year 2023: **134 victims killed or injured** in total fatal-and-injury crashes; **33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions**; **17 pedestrian** and **14 bicyclist victims killed or injured**. These are not total crashes. https://www.ots.ca.gov/rankings/novato-2023/
California Office of Traffic Safety, Marin County 2023	county profile for calendar year 2023: **1,323 victims killed or injured** in total fatal-and-injury crashes; **381 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions**; **101 pedestrian**, **138 bicyclist**, and **89 motorcycle victims killed or injured**. The OTS methodology says county profiles include all roadways within county limits. https://www.ots.ca.gov/rankings/marin-county-2023/
California Department of Transportation, 2024 Crash Data on California State Highways (Road Miles, Travel, Crashes, Crash Rates)	Marin County, state highways only, calendar year 2024; table prepared March 18, 2026: **660 crashes**, comprising **404 property-damage-only**, **251 injury**, and **5 fatal** crashes; **5 people killed** and **344 people injured**. This is countywide state-highway coverage, not a Novato or individual-route total. https://dot.ca.gov/-/media/dot-

	media/programs/research-innovation-system-information/documents/annual-collision-data/2024-crash-data-on-cshwy-book-v3-a11y.pdf
Transportation Authority of Marin, **Highway 101 Interchange and Approaching Roadway Study	Existing Conditions, Constraints, and Opportunities Report: Alameda Del Prado/Nave Drive** — limited Novato interchange study area on local roads and ramps, using SWITRS for 2014–2018: **14 reported collisions**; **4 (29%) injury collisions**, all minor. All four injury collisions were on the northbound or southbound US 101 off-ramps; **3 of 4** were categorized as unsafe speed and **1 of 4** as DUI. This cannot be generalized to all of US 101 or Novato. https://www.tam.ca.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/10/10-ADP-Final_Report.pdf
County of Marin, Roadway Safety Review – 2018 Travel Safety Plan (Board accepted December 18, 2018)	2012–2016, countywide local non-state arterial and collector roads across unincorporated Marin and incorporated cities/towns: **2,756 reported crashes**; **219 (8%) fatal or serious-injury crashes**; **11% pedestrian-involved crashes** while pedestrians were involved in **20% of fatal/serious-injury crashes**; **29% involved unsafe speed**. The plan identified a high-collision network of **68 roadway segments and 93 intersections**. https://publicworks.marincounty.gov/traffic-safety-analysis/ ; supporting presentation: https://marin.granicus.com/DocumentViewer.php?file=marin_a1b09d9716e4171597204541fc4efc53.pdf
Caltrans, SR37 Project Background	the 21-mile SR 37 corridor linking I-80 and US 101 across Sonoma, Marin, and Solano counties. Caltrans documents weekday and weekend congestion, uneven subsidence, and intermittent storm-related flooding. It does **not** provide a collision count on this page, so these conditions should be presented as corridor-operating context rather than crash statistics. https://dot.ca.gov/caltrans-near-me/district-

	4/d4-projects/d4-37-corridor-projects/37-background

Required attribution for local-impact cards: “Unless otherwise noted, figures are from California Office of Traffic Safety, Caltrans, Marin County, and Transportation Authority of Marin publications. They describe the stated year, geography, roadway system, and measure (crashes or people killed/injured) only; they are not an exhaustive count of all Novato-area collisions and should not be used to assign fault in any individual event.”

Local-Evidence Limitations

No source reviewed supplies a verified all-crash, all-jurisdiction, citywide Novato total. OTS city profiles report people killed or injured and selected fatal/injury collision categories, not property-damage-only crashes; their city coverage is incorporated-city data on local streets and state highways within city limits that share CHP jurisdiction, and CHP-reported crashes on shared-jurisdiction roads do not count against the city. Caltrans’ 2024 table covers crashes on state highways only across all of Marin County, not all roads, not Novato alone, and not route-specific US 101 or SR 37 totals. The TAM Alameda del Prado/Nave Drive evidence is a small, dated 2014–2018 local-road-and-ramp study area, not a US 101 mainline or citywide total. The 2018 Marin Travel Safety Plan is historical and explicitly covers local non-state arterial and collector roads. SWITRS/TIMS data have a typical 12–18-month entry lag; TIMS identifies 2024 and later as provisional, and its maps display only crashes SafeTREC geocoded (roughly 97% overall). Individual media reports or incident posts must not be summed into citywide totals. Aggregate categories indicate reported patterns, not proof of fault or causation in a particular collision.

Video Validation Matrix

#	Lesson	California determination	Required handling	QTE
1	Scanning Ahead for Lane-End Warnings	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Suitable as a brief supplemental hazard-scanning clip only with an accompanying California edit card or instructor narration replacing “two blocks” with	RECOMMENDED

			“at least 10 seconds ahead” and teaching the required lane-change checks.	
2	After a Collision: California’s Required Next Steps	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only as an externally linked, teacher-reviewed discussion prompt with the California corrections displayed immediately alongside it; do not use the unedited $5,000 police rule as California instruction.	RECOMMENDED
3	Build a California-Ready Vehicle Emergency Kit	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only with the California corrections/overlay above and a rights-clearance check before reuse; do not treat the Short as a stand-alone California roadside-safety lesson or as proof that the listed kit is legally required.	NOT NEEDED
4	Stopping Safely Before a Front Curb: Use Your Own Visual Reference	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only as a linked, supplemental California micro-tip after adding the listed safety and jurisdictional edits; do not re-upload, screen-record, or embed it.	RECOMMENDED

5	California: What to Do at a Nonworking Traffic Light	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only with the California replacement language or instructor overlay that states the all-way-stop rule and first-arrival/tie-right-of-way sequence; do not present the unedited Short as complete California instruction.	RECOMMENDED
6	California: Pull Right and Stop for Approaching Emergency Vehicles	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only with the California-specific edits above and rights clearance; do not present the Short unchanged as a complete California rule, and do not re-upload or embed it without permission.	RECOMMENDED
7	Emergency Vehicles: California’s Right-Edge Yield Rule	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only with California-localized on-screen correction or facilitator narration that changes the left-side pull-over to the California right-edge rule and adds the intersection instruction; do not use as a standalone	RECOMMENDED

			California rules clip.	
8	California Right-of-Way: Who Goes First at Intersections?	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only with the listed California edits, ideally as a linked reference accompanied by a California-specific diagram or instructor narration; do not use it as standalone California instruction.	RECOMMENDED
9	California High-Beam Choices: Dark Roads, Rain, and Fog	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only as an edited, California-context supplemental teaching reference after the listed corrections are added; do not reuse, embed, or redistribute the video unless permission or an appropriate license is independently confirmed.	RECOMMENDED
10	Passing a Bicyclist Safely in California: Give 3 Feet	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only as a linked/viewed supplemental example after California-specific captioning or instructor framing incorporates the listed edits.	RECOMMENDED
11	Entering a California	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA	Use only as a supplementary	RECOMMENDED

	Freeway Safely: Match Speed, Signal, Scan, Merge	EDITS	visual after adding California-specific narration, captions, or instruction covering yielding, speed matching, signaling, shoulder checks, permitted lane markings, and safe gap selection; do not use it as a stand-alone California freeway-entry lesson.	
12	California Freeway Merging: Match Speed, Check, Signal, and Yield	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use with the listed California narration or text edits and a California DMV citation; do not use unedited as complete freeway-merging instruction.	RECOMMENDED
13	California Drive-Test Readiness: Scan, Space, and Core Maneuvers	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only as a brief engagement opener with the listed California overlays or instructor narration; do not use it as standalone California test-preparation instruction.	NOT NEEDED
14	California Blind-Spot Checks: Look Over Both Shoulders	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only as a short visual prompt after the listed California	RECOMMENDED

			edits are presented by an instructor or on-screen overlay; do not present its specific "not that far back" viewing angle or right-hand-drive demonstration as the California rule.	
15	Slow Down for Blind Curves and Parked Cars: California Driving	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only as a California-localized discussion clip with the listed on-screen or narrated corrections; do not present its left-side road position as a California driving model.	RECOMMENDED
16	Blind Bends and Parked Cars: California Poor-Visibility Driving	NOT RECOMMENDED	Do not use, embed, or assign the original Short as California driver education.	RECOMMENDED
17	Making Space for a Trailer-Towing Vehicle Merging on a Freeway	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only with California-specific narration or overlays covering the three-second rule, easing off the accelerator after a close merge, and the freeway-entry space rule; do not use the Short alone as California driver-	RECOMMENDED

			education instruction.	
18	Why More Speed Requires More Stopping Space	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use only with the listed California overlays or instructor framing; treat it as a linked visual reference rather than standalone California instruction, and obtain rights-holder permission before any reuse beyond platform viewing.	RECOMMENDED
19	Use the California Three-Second Following-Distance Check	ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Instructionally usable only with the stated California edits and with separate rights/permission clearance before any reuse; do not download, re-upload, or embed the video while the license remains unverified.	NOT NEEDED
20	California: Drive Distraction-Free	APPROPRIATE WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use as an instructor-led, link-only supplementary lesson if the exact URL is playable at delivery.	RECOMMENDED
21	A DUI Affects More Than the Driver	APPROPRIATE WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use as a 30-second instructor-framed	RECOMMENDED

			reinforcement after Section 7 reading.	
22	California Child Passenger Safety: Seats, Belts, and the Back Seat	APPROPRIATE WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use as a linked/view-only supplementary lesson with a current 2025-handbook knowledge check.	RECOMMENDED
23	California Railroad Crossings: Drive Safely Near Trains	APPROPRIATE WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS	Use as an instructor-framed supplemental viewing resource with the California corrections presented before or after viewing.	RECOMMENDED

Lesson-by-Lesson California Edits and Assessment Content

1. Scanning Ahead for Lane-End Warnings

Category: Road Awareness
Source video: How to Navigate and be Aware of Hazards and Changes
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Learn how to scan ahead, across the roadway, and for warning signs in unfamiliar areas. A right-lane-ends sign illustrates why early information helps drivers plan a lawful, smooth lane change rather than making a last-minute move.

Required California handling.

- Replace the fixed instruction “look at least two blocks” with California’s usable standard: keep eyes moving and scan at least 10 seconds ahead. Block length, speed, and sight distance vary, so two blocks is not a California rule.
- After identifying a lane-ends warning, add the California lane-change sequence: signal, check mirrors and traffic behind/beside, look over the shoulder, check blind spots for vehicles, motorcyclists, and bicyclists, and move only when there is sufficient space.

- State explicitly that early observation supports a lawful, non-last-minute decision; it does not justify weaving, forcing a merge, or stopping abruptly in the travel lane.

Knowledge check. You are traveling in a lane that ends ahead. After seeing the warning sign early, what is the safest California-compliant response?

- A. Accelerate and merge immediately without signaling so no one blocks you.
- B. Signal, check mirrors and traffic, look over your shoulder and check blind spots, then change lanes only when there is enough space.
- C. Stop in the lane as soon as you see the warning sign.
- D. Wait until the lane ends, then force your way into the next lane.

Correct response: B. Signal, check mirrors and traffic, look over your shoulder and check blind spots, then change lanes only when there is enough space.

Why: California’ s “Changing Lanes” guidance requires signaling, mirror and traffic checks, a shoulder/blind-spot check, and sufficient space before moving. Its Safe Driving guidance also calls for scanning ahead to avoid last-minute moves; a lane-ends warning should prompt early planning, not a forced merge or abrupt stop.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Branching scenario: A right-lane-ends warning appears ahead on a multilane road. Let the learner choose to (1) scan early and, when a safe gap exists, signal/check mirrors, shoulder, and blind spots before a smooth merge; (2) continue scanning and maintain lane/space until a safe gap becomes available; or (3) attempt a last-minute/unsignaled merge. Safe outcomes reinforce early planning and merging only after all checks; the unsafe choice receives corrective feedback, not a crash simulation.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — no Creative Commons license was explicitly visible on the public YouTube watch page consulted.

2. After a Collision: California’ s Required Next Steps

Category: Emergencies
Source video: How to Deal with a Crash
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

California crash response: stop, check for injuries, move out of traffic only if no one is hurt, call 911, exchange required identification and insurance information, and complete required reports. This review corrects the video’ s police and reporting thresholds.

Required California handling.

- Replace the video’ s $5,000 police threshold. California’ s handbook says to call 911 right away if anyone is hurt; if no one is hurt, move the vehicle out of traffic and then call 911. The handbook does not use $5,000 as this threshold.
- State that a driver must stop. Leaving the scene is a hit-and-run; ‘pull over if safe’ should not imply that stopping is optional.
- Expand the information-exchange instruction: show the other driver, law enforcement, and others involved your driver’ s license, vehicle registration card, insurance information, and current address—not only a name, phone number, plate, and insurance.
- Add required reporting: report to law enforcement within 24 hours if anyone is injured or killed; file DMV form SR-1 within 10 days if property damage exceeds $1,000 or anyone is injured or killed, regardless of fault. Law enforcement does not file the SR-1 for the driver.

Knowledge check. After a California collision in which no one is hurt and your vehicle can be moved, what is the correct next step?

- Drive away after exchanging insurance information.
- Move the vehicle out of traffic, then call 911.
- Call police only if visible damage exceeds $5,000.
- Wait 24 hours before deciding whether to report the collision.

Correct response: Move the vehicle out of traffic, then call 911.

Why: California’ s handbook directs drivers to move a vehicle out of traffic if no one is hurt and then call 911. It also requires stopping, exchanging specified information, and filing an SR-1 with DMV within 10 days when property damage exceeds $1,000 or anyone is injured or killed (p. 59).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Use a short text-based branching prompt, not a crash simulation: “You are in a low-speed collision. If anyone is hurt, choose stop and call 911 right away. If no one is hurt and the vehicle can move, choose move out of traffic and call 911.” Both safe outcomes then require showing license, registration, insurance information, and current address; a final branch checks whether the $1,000/any-injury SR-1 threshold applies.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the consulted public YouTube watch-page extraction did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license designation.

3. Build a California-Ready Vehicle Emergency Kit

Category: Car Readiness
Source video: Pack an Emergency Kit
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Build a basic vehicle emergency kit with a flashlight and extra batteries, jumper cables, and a first-aid kit. In California, a kit supports readiness, but roadside safety also means pulling over safely, using flashers, and waiting in the vehicle for help.

Required California handling.

- Replace the absolute claim that every car "needs" this kit with: "A basic emergency kit is a recommended preparedness measure; these items are not presented in the handbook as a California legal equipment requirement."
- Add California roadside-action guidance: if vehicle trouble requires stopping, activate emergency flashers, pull completely off the road when possible, call for roadside assistance, and remain in the vehicle until help arrives.
- For a freeway disability, add the California-specific direction to pull safely to the right shoulder; if exiting is necessary, use the right side away from traffic, then return to the belted vehicle and wait for help.

Knowledge check. Your vehicle stops working on a California freeway. Which response best follows the California Driver’ s Handbook?

- A. Safely pull to the right shoulder, seek assistance, return to the vehicle from the right side if you exited, stay belted inside until help arrives, and use emergency flashers as appropriate.
- B. Stop in the nearest lane, open the hood, and begin using jumper cables immediately.
- C. Leave the vehicle on the left side and walk along the freeway to find help.
- D. Stay in the travel lane with no lights on so other drivers can pass around you.

Correct response: A. Safely pull to the right shoulder, seek assistance, return to the vehicle from the right side if you exited, stay belted inside until help arrives, and use emergency flashers as appropriate.

Why: Section 6, "If Your Vehicle Becomes Disabled on the Freeway" (p. 53), directs drivers to pull safely to the right shoulder, get assistance, use the right side if they must exit, return to the vehicle, stay inside with the seat belt on until help arrives, and use flashers at their discretion. The Short's kit may help preparedness but does not substitute for these roadside-safety steps.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California

OTS, Novato 2023]

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the consulted public YouTube watch page did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license.

4. Stopping Safely Before a Front Curb: Use Your Own Visual Reference

Category: Vehicle Control
Source video: Parking Tips
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Practice pulling slowly toward a front curb without contact. A side-mirror reference can help in your own vehicle, but it does not replace checking for people, observing curb restrictions, and leaving a safe gap.

Required California handling.

- Present the mirror alignment as a vehicle-, seat-position-, and mirror-adjustment-specific practice reference—not a California rule, universal stopping point, or guaranteed clearance measurement.
- Add: move at walking speed, keep looking ahead and around the vehicle, and stop/yield for pedestrians, bicyclists, or other roadway users; do not fixate on the mirror reference.
- Add: a clear gap from a curb does not make parking legal. Check curb color, posted restrictions, and location; never block a sidewalk, driveway, or wheelchair-access curb.
- Do not imply that the handbook's 18-inch rule applies to front-curb parking; it is stated for parallel parking on p. 18.

Knowledge check. True or False: A side-mirror alignment point shown in a video proves it is legal to park at any curb.

- True
- False

Correct response: False

Why: The alignment point is only a vehicle-specific visual reference and is not a legal parking test. California's handbook states that colored curbs have specific rules and prohibits parking on or partially blocking a sidewalk, in front of a driveway, or at a curb providing wheelchair access (Parking at Colored Curbs and Illegal Parking, p. 20).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 17 pedestrian and 14 bicyclist victims killed or injured. Scan and yield before every lateral movement. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. At walking speed, approach an unpainted front curb in an otherwise lawful parking space. A pedestrian begins crossing ahead: choose to stop and yield, then recheck the path. Once clear, use a pre-practiced mirror reference only as a secondary cue, stop with visible clearance, and select another space if the curb is red, blue, posted, or blocks access. Safe outcomes: yield and stop; park only where lawful with a clear gap; or choose another space.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the consulted public watch page did not explicitly display a Creative Commons or other license designation.

5. California: What to Do at a Nonworking Traffic Light

Category: Rules and Laws
Source video: How to Handle a Traffic Light Outage
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

A dark traffic light is not a free pass. In California, stop as though every approach has a STOP sign, establish who arrived first, yield when required, and enter only when the intersection is clear.

Required California handling.

- Replace "Treat it like a stop sign" with: "In California, when a traffic light is not working, stop as if the intersection has STOP signs in all directions. Then proceed cautiously when it is safe."
- Replace "If you're unsure ... always yield to the driver on the right" with: "At the all-way stop, the first road user to arrive and stop goes first. If road users arrive at the same time, yield to the road user on your right. Check for pedestrians, bicyclists, and other traffic before entering."

Knowledge check. At a California intersection where the traffic light is completely not working, you and another driver stop at the same time, and the other driver is on your right. What should you do?

- Proceed first because you are going straight.
- Yield to the driver on your right, then proceed cautiously when it is safe.
- Follow the last color shown by the signal.
- Proceed without stopping if no pedestrian is visible.

Correct response: Yield to the driver on your right, then proceed cautiously when it is safe.

Why: California instructs drivers at a nonworking traffic light to stop as if STOP signs control all directions. At that all-way-stop situation, the first arrival goes first; when road users arrive at the same time, yield to the road user on the right. Enter only when safe. ("Traffic Light Not Working," p. 25; "Intersections," p. 30.)

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Safe branching decision exercise: At a four-way intersection with a dark signal, first choose to make a complete stop. Branch 1: if the learner stopped first, they check pedestrians, bicyclists, and cross traffic, then proceed cautiously when clear. Branch 2: if a vehicle on the right stopped simultaneously, the learner yields, waits for it to clear, then proceeds cautiously. No collision depiction or crash simulation.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — no Creative Commons or other license designation was explicitly visible in the public YouTube watch-page text reviewed.

6. California: Pull Right and Stop for Approaching Emergency Vehicles

Category: Rules and Laws
Source video: Emergency Vehicle Right of Way
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

When an emergency vehicle uses a siren and red lights, California drivers must yield, pull to the right edge, and stop until it passes. If you are already in an intersection, clear it first, then pull right and stop safely.

Required California handling.

- State California's trigger precisely: yield to a law enforcement vehicle, fire engine, ambulance, or other emergency vehicle using a siren and red lights.
- Add: Drive to the right edge of the road and stop until the emergency vehicle or vehicles have passed.
- Add the intersection exception: do not stop in an intersection; continue through it, then drive right and stop as soon as it is safe.
- Revise the traffic advice: do not make an unsafe movement; when safe, move to the right edge and stop. It must not replace the pull-right-and-stop rule.

Knowledge check. You are already in an intersection when an ambulance approaches using a siren and red lights. What should you do?

- A. Stop immediately in the intersection.
- B. Continue through the intersection, then drive to the right edge and stop as soon as it is safe.
- C. Stay in your lane and keep driving at the same speed.
- D. Follow the ambulance through the intersection.

Correct response: B. Continue through the intersection, then drive to the right edge and stop as soon as it is safe.

Why: The handbook's "Emergency Vehicles" guidance directs a driver already in an intersection to continue through it, then drive right and stop as soon as safe; it also directs drivers to stop until the emergency vehicle or vehicles have passed (p. 35; PDF p. 39).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Branching scenario: a driver hears a siren and sees red lights while already in an intersection. Choosing to stop in the intersection explains that it blocks the path; choosing to clear the intersection, then pull to the right edge and stop confirms the California rule. Use simple road imagery only, never a crash simulation.

Media status: UNVERIFIED: the consulted public YouTube watch-page text did not explicitly show a Creative Commons license designation.

7. Emergency Vehicles: California’ s Right-Edge Yield Rule

Category: Rules and Laws
Source video: Right of Way with Emergency Vehicles
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

When an emergency vehicle approaches with a siren and red lights, California drivers must safely move to the right edge and stop until it passes. Do not copy this clip’ s left-side positioning.

Required California handling.

- Replace the clip’ s left-side maneuver with California’ s rule: safely drive to the right edge of the road and stop until the emergency vehicle or vehicles have passed.
- Add the California intersection rule: if already in an intersection when an emergency vehicle is seen, continue through it; then move right as soon as safe and stop.
- Make clear that the California rule applies to a law-enforcement vehicle, fire engine, ambulance, or other emergency vehicle using a siren and red lights.

> **Traffic-side localization:** The source visual uses left-side traffic. In California, follow the stated right-side/right-edge rule. The visual is a discussion example, not a road-position model.

Knowledge check. In California, you are already in an intersection when an ambulance using a siren and red lights approaches. What should you do?

- A. Stop immediately in the intersection.

- B. Continue through the intersection, then safely move to the right edge and stop until the ambulance passes.
- C. Move to the left edge and stop.
- D. Speed up through the next intersection before yielding.

Correct response: B. Continue through the intersection, then safely move to the right edge and stop until the ambulance passes.

Why: The 2025 California Quick Reference Driver’ s Handbook directs drivers already in an intersection to continue through it, then drive to the right as soon as safe and stop. It also directs drivers to give right-of-way to emergency vehicles using a siren and red lights and to stop until they have passed ("Emergency Vehicles," p. 35).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. A short, non-crash branching prompt: an ambulance with siren and red lights appears behind you as you approach an intersection. If already in the intersection, choose to clear it before signaling, moving to the right edge, and stopping; if not yet in it, choose the right edge and stop. Safe outcomes reinforce both California-compliant paths.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public watch-page review did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license designation.

8. California Right-of-Way: Who Goes First at Intersections?

Category: Rules and Laws
Source video: Right of Way
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Learn California intersection priority: the first road user normally goes first; at the same time, yield to the road user on your right. Signal-controlled, T, turning, and pedestrian situations require additional rules and caution.

Required California handling.

- Replace the broad statement ‘At an intersection, the car on your right has the right-of-way’ with: ‘At an uncontrolled intersection without STOP or YIELD signs, the road user that arrives first goes first; if road users arrive at the same time, yield to the vehicle, pedestrian, or bicyclist on your right.’
- Do not present ‘the car going straight goes first’ as a general simultaneous-arrival rule. California uses the right-side rule at an uncontrolled/all-way-stop tie; at a T intersection, traffic on the through road has right-of-way; a left turner must yield to an approaching vehicle close enough to be dangerous.

- Keep the four-way-stop rule, but say ‘the first road user to arrive goes first; if they arrive at the same time, yield to the road user on your right,’ and include pedestrians and bicyclists rather than only cars.
- Add that signals, STOP/YIELD signs, and road-user position control the decision; pedestrians always have right-of-way at intersections.

Knowledge check. At an uncontrolled intersection with no STOP or YIELD signs, you and a bicyclist arrive at the same time, and the bicyclist is on your right. What should you do?

- A. Proceed because you are driving straight.
- B. Yield to the bicyclist, then proceed when the intersection is clear.
- C. Accelerate through before the bicyclist enters the intersection.
- D. Honk to tell the bicyclist that you are going first.

Correct response: B. Yield to the bicyclist, then proceed when the intersection is clear.

Why: California’s ‘Intersections’ rule states that at an intersection without STOP or YIELD signs, the first arrival has right-of-way; if a vehicle, pedestrian, or bicyclist arrives at the same time, yield to the road user on your right (Section 5, p. 30).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 17 pedestrian and 14 bicyclist victims killed or injured. Scan and yield before every lateral movement. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Four-way-stop decision: The learner has made a complete stop as another car stops simultaneously on the learner’s right; a pedestrian is waiting to cross. Branches let the learner yield to the pedestrian and the vehicle on the right, then proceed only when the crosswalk and intersection are clear; if the learner stopped first, the safe outcome is to check for road users and proceed cautiously. Do not depict a crash or near-crash.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public YouTube watch page was checked, and no Creative Commons license was explicitly visible.

9. California High-Beam Choices: Dark Roads, Rain, and Fog

Category: Weather and Night Driving
Source video: High Beam Usage
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Use high beams on open country roads or dark city streets when they improve visibility without blinding others. In California, use low beams in rain, fog, or heavy smoke, and always drive at a speed that lets you stop within what you can see.

Required California handling.

- Replace the narrow description ‘very dark, open roads’ with California’s wording: high beams may be used on open country roads or dark city streets, subject to safety and legality.
- Change ‘heavy rain’ to ‘rain’: the California handbook directs drivers to use low-beam headlights whenever it is raining.
- Add: ‘Drive at a speed that lets you stop within the distance lit by your headlights.’
- Add: ‘Do not use high beams where they are illegal; dim them to avoid blinding an oncoming driver.’

Knowledge check. At night on a dark California road, an oncoming driver appears. What should you do with your high beams?

- Keep high beams on until the other vehicle passes.
- Dim to low beams to avoid blinding the oncoming driver.
- Turn on parking lights only.
- Flash the high beams repeatedly.

Correct response: Dim to low beams to avoid blinding the oncoming driver.

Why: California’s 2025 Quick Reference Driver’s Handbook directs drivers to dim high-beam headlights to avoid blinding the driver of an oncoming vehicle (Section 6, Safe Driving — Understand the Road Conditions: Darkness, p. 46).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Branching scenario: On a dark, open road, the learner first confirms high beams are legal and no road user will be blinded; high beams are an available choice. When an oncoming vehicle appears, the safe outcome is to select low beams. In a rain, fog, or heavy-smoke branch, the safe outcome is low beams, slower travel, and maintaining a speed that allows stopping within visible space. Do not depict a collision.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public YouTube watch-page check did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license designation.

10. Passing a Bicyclist Safely in California: Give 3 Feet

Category: Road Awareness
Source video: How to Share the Road with a Cyclist
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

When driving behind a bicyclist, wait for a safe passing opportunity, change lanes where safe, leave at least three feet of clearance, and return only after you are safely past. If three

feet is unavailable, stay behind and wait.

Required California handling.

- California-localize the clearance statement to: “Leave at least 3 feet when passing a bicyclist.” The Short’s one-meter minimum is approximately 3.28 feet and is not unsafe, but feet are the handbook’s stated California standard.
- Add: “If you cannot provide at least 3 feet, do not pass; slow and wait for a safe opportunity.”
- Add a lane-change check: before moving left or returning right, check mirrors and blind spots and merge only when safe; rearview-mirror visibility alone is not the full California lookout instruction.

Knowledge check. You are behind a bicyclist on a narrow two-lane road, and oncoming traffic prevents you from safely moving left. Passing now would leave less than 3 feet of clearance. What should you do?

- A. Pass slowly while staying as far left as possible in your lane.
- B. Sound the horn and pass before the oncoming vehicle reaches you.
- C. Slow down and wait until you can safely pass with at least 3 feet of clearance.
- D. Drive partly onto the shoulder to create room.

Correct response: C. Slow down and wait until you can safely pass with at least 3 feet of clearance.

Why: The handbook says that if you cannot give a bicyclist three feet of space, do not pass until that clearance can be given. For an oncoming-traffic conflict, it specifically says to slow down and let the oncoming vehicle pass rather than drive between it and the bicyclist (Section 5, p. 37; Section 6, p. 52).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 17 pedestrian and 14 bicyclist victims killed or injured. Scan and yield before every lateral movement. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Branching scenario: A driver approaches a bicyclist on a two-lane street as an oncoming vehicle arrives. Safe outcome 1: slow and follow until the oncoming vehicle clears, then move left and pass with at least 3 feet. Safe outcome 2: if clearance remains unavailable, continue waiting behind the bicyclist. Do not depict a collision or near-crash.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public YouTube watch page was consulted and did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license designation.

11. Entering a California Freeway Safely: Match Speed, Signal, Scan, Merge

Category: Lane Changes and Turning
Source video: How to enter a ramp on the highway
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Use the on-ramp to approach highway speed, signal, check mirrors and your blind spot, yield to freeway traffic, and enter only when a gap is large enough. Never cross solid lines; avoid stopping unless absolutely necessary.

Required California handling.

- Add that freeway traffic has the right-of-way. The entering driver must yield, approach at or near the speed of traffic, and merge only when a space is large enough to join safely; do not stop unless absolutely necessary.
- Add and visibly model the California scan-and-signal sequence: use mirrors, activate the turn signal, then quickly look over the shoulder for blind spots before merging. For a freeway lane change, California says to signal at least five seconds beforehand.
- State that the lane boundary may be crossed only where permitted: do not cross solid lines. The animation appears to merge after the separator changes from solid to broken, but it does not explain that rule.
- Add the requirement to maintain at least three seconds of space behind the vehicle ahead after joining the lane.

Knowledge check. While entering a California highway from an on-ramp, which action is correct?

- A. Stop at the end of the acceleration lane whenever the first visible gap is too small.
- B. Move into the highway lane immediately because freeway traffic must make room for entering vehicles.
- C. Approach at or near traffic speed, use mirrors and a turn signal, make a quick shoulder check, yield to highway traffic, and merge only into a space large enough to join safely where the markings permit.
- D. Drive over the solid white line whenever a vehicle behind you leaves any opening.

Correct response: C

Why: California’ s “Merging And Exiting — Merging” guidance says highway traffic has the right-of-way and directs entering drivers to be at or near traffic speed, use mirrors and turn signals, quickly look over the shoulder, merge when safe into a space large enough, and avoid crossing solid lines (pp. 15–16). “Right-of-Way Rules: Who Goes First” further requires drivers entering traffic to yield to traffic already in the lanes (p. 30).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Branching safe-decision scenario: the learner is in a straight acceleration lane and sees a too-small opening ahead but a potentially adequate opening behind. Safe outcomes are (1) signal, check mirrors and blind spot, match traffic speed, yield, and merge only when the adequate space is confirmed at a permitted broken-line opening; or (2) keep yielding and adjust speed for another adequate gap, stopping only if absolutely necessary. Do not depict a collision or a forced merge.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public YouTube watch-page material consulted did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license designation.

12. California Freeway Merging: Match Speed, Check, Signal, and Yield

Category: Lane Changes and Turning
Source video: Common Mistakes when Merging Onto a Highway
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

California freeway entrances require more than matching traffic speed: use the on-ramp, choose a safe gap, signal, check mirrors and blind spots, and yield to highway traffic. This edited clip reinforces the timing lesson with California-specific steps.

Required California handling.

- Add: Traffic already on the highway has the right-of-way. Yield and merge only when it is safe into a space large enough for your vehicle.
- Add the required observation-and-communication sequence: use mirrors and turn signal, then quickly look over your shoulder for the blind spot before merging.
- Replace the absolute-sounding do not brake late message with: Plan early and avoid panic braking, but do not stop on the ramp unless absolutely necessary; maintain enough room to stop safely and leave at least three seconds behind the vehicle ahead after merging.
- Add: Do not cross a solid line when merging; if crossing several lanes, signal and cross one lane at a time, checking blind spots each time.

Knowledge check. On a California freeway on-ramp, which sequence best follows DMV guidance?

- Accelerate and merge into the first available opening so through traffic must adjust.
- Stop at the end of the ramp before choosing a gap whenever traffic is heavy.
- Be at or near traffic speed, yield to highway traffic, use mirrors and a signal, check over

your shoulder, and merge into a sufficiently large gap without crossing a solid line.

- Match traffic speed and merge as soon as possible; a signal and blind-spot check are optional when the lane appears clear.

Correct response: Be at or near traffic speed, yield to highway traffic, use mirrors and a signal, check over your shoulder, and merge into a sufficiently large gap without crossing a solid line.

Why: California DMV states that highway traffic has the right-of-way and requires drivers entering a highway to be at or near traffic speed, merge only when safe into a sufficiently large space, use mirrors and turn signals, shoulder-check before merging, and avoid crossing solid lines; see Merging and Exiting—Merging, pp. 15–16.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Branching decision: While approaching a California freeway entrance, select the safe response. If a sufficiently large gap is available after mirror, signal, and shoulder check, merge at or near traffic speed without crossing a solid line; if no adequate gap is available, continue using the available ramp space, adjust speed while yielding, and stop only if absolutely necessary.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public YouTube watch-page material consulted did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license.

13. California Drive-Test Readiness: Scan, Space, and Core Maneuvers

Category: Vehicle Control
Source video: Driving Test Tips
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Quick California-focused reminders for a behind-the-wheel test: practice core maneuvers, signal and shoulder-check before lane changes, scan ahead, maintain a three-second following gap, and obey signs and safe-speed rules. Use with the California DMV handbook and instructor feedback.

Required California handling.

- Replace the general instruction to ‘keep glancing at your mirrors’ with California’s complete lane-change sequence: signal, check mirrors and traffic beside/behind, look over the shoulder for blind spots, and move only when there is enough space (p. 8). Mirrors do not reveal blind spots.
- Make ‘enough distance’ measurable: California directs drivers to use the three-second rule for a safe following distance (p. 44).

- Qualify ‘follow the speed limit’: in California, a driver may never travel faster than is safe for current road conditions, even if under the posted limit (Basic Speed Law, p. 52).
- Add California-specific maneuver details when teaching the listed basics: signal about 100 feet before turns; use the prescribed lane position and check for pedestrians, bicyclists, and motorcyclists; for parallel parking, check blind spots and finish within 18 inches of the curb (pp. 11–18).

Knowledge check. Before changing lanes in California, which sequence is required?

- Check mirrors only, then move when the lane looks open.
- Signal, check mirrors and traffic beside/behind, look over your shoulder for blind spots, and move only when there is enough space.
- Slow sharply, turn on the signal, and move immediately.
- Honk, check the rearview mirror, and drift into the next lane.

Correct response: Signal, check mirrors and traffic beside/behind, look over your shoulder for blind spots, and move only when there is enough space.

Why: California’s ‘Changing Lanes’ guidance requires signaling, mirror and traffic checks, a shoulder check for blind spots, and sufficient space before moving (Section 4, p. 8). The handbook specifically warns not to let the vehicle drift into another lane.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public YouTube watch page consulted did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license.

14. California Blind-Spot Checks: Look Over Both Shoulders

Category: Road Awareness
Source video: How to Identify and Reduce Blind Spots
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Blind spots remain outside mirror view. Before changing lanes, merging, turning, backing, or leaving a curb, check both side windows over your shoulders while keeping your body and steering wheel steady—especially where a cyclist may be alongside.

Required California handling.

- Replace the blanket advice that a driver need not look "that far back" with California’s rule: look over both the right and left shoulders out the side windows; the precise viewing angle must not be taught as a universal limit.

- Add that the driver turns only their head for the check—never the whole body or steering wheel.
- Add the California-required contexts: check blind spots before changing lanes, turning at an intersection, merging, backing, leaving a parking space, parallel parking, pulling from a curb, and opening a car door.
- Frame mirrors as a supplement, not a substitute: California states blind spots cannot be seen using mirrors alone.

Knowledge check. Before changing lanes in California, which action best checks for a vehicle or cyclist hidden in a blind spot?

- Rely on the interior rearview mirror because it covers both adjacent lanes.
- Look over both right and left shoulders out the side windows, turning only your head, in addition to mirror checks.
- Turn your whole body toward the lane while steering into it.
- Look only as far back as the rear passenger window, regardless of the vehicle or traffic situation.

Correct response: Look over both right and left shoulders out the side windows, turning only your head, in addition to mirror checks.

Why: California’ s handbook explains that blind spots cannot be seen by looking straight ahead or using mirrors, directs drivers to look over both shoulders out the side windows, and says to turn only the head—not the body or steering wheel—before a lane change (Section 6, "Blind Spots," p. 45).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 17 pedestrian and 14 bicyclist victims killed or injured. Scan and yield before every lateral movement. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Branching scenario: A driver intends to merge one lane left while a cyclist may be traveling alongside. Learner choices are mirror-only, turn the body/steering wheel, or keep the vehicle straight and check the relevant side window over the shoulder; safe outcomes reinforce delaying the merge until the blind spot is clear and completing the maneuver only when safe.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public YouTube watch page reviewed did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license designation.

15. Slow Down for Blind Curves and Parked Cars: California Driving

Category: Weather and Night Driving
Source video: How to Adapt to the Conditions
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Approach a blind residential curve at a speed safe for limited visibility, parked vehicles, and possible oncoming traffic. This footage uses left-hand traffic, so California learners must keep right and yield space rather than copy its lane position.

Required California handling.

- Add a prominent California localization: this footage uses left-hand traffic. In California, do not copy the shown left-side road position; remain on the right side of the roadway except when a lawful, safe maneuver requires otherwise.
- Replace the nonspecific instruction “take it slow” with: reduce speed to one that is safe for the blind curve, restricted sight distance, parked vehicles, and possible oncoming traffic under California’s Basic Speed Law.
- Add: if a conflict develops around the blind bend, slow or stop as needed and let the oncoming vehicle clear rather than trying to pass through a narrowed space at the same time.

> **Traffic-side localization:** The source visual uses left-side traffic. In California, follow the stated right-side/right-edge rule. The visual is a discussion example, not a road-position model.

Knowledge check. On a California residential street, you approach a blind curve narrowed by parked cars and cannot see whether a vehicle is coming. What is the safest action?

- Maintain your speed and move left early to create room.
- Slow to a speed safe for the limited sight distance, stay on the California/right side as appropriate, and let an oncoming vehicle clear before taking a narrowed gap.
- Accelerate through the curve before another vehicle arrives.
- Drive in the center so an oncoming driver must move over.

Correct response: Slow to a speed safe for the limited sight distance, stay on the California/right side as appropriate, and let an oncoming vehicle clear before taking a narrowed gap.

Why: Section 6’s “Manage Your Speed” (p. 52) applies the Basic Speed Law: a driver may never go faster than is safe for current road conditions. “Choose Between Hazards” (p. 52) directs drivers facing hazards on both sides to slow down and take one danger at a time, rather than forcing a narrow simultaneous pass.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. At a clear daytime blind curve with parked cars narrowing both sides, let the learner choose whether to slow and hold a safe California/right-side position, accelerate, or center the vehicle. Safe outcomes: slowing early leaves time to detect an

oncoming vehicle; waiting for it to pass preserves space before proceeding. Do not depict a collision.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the consulted public YouTube watch page did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license.

16. Blind Bends and Parked Cars: California Poor-Visibility Driving

Category: Weather and Night Driving
Source video: How to Adapt to the Conditions, Poor Visibility
California determination: NOT RECOMMENDED

On a narrow California street with a blind bend and parked cars, reduce speed, scan for pedestrians, stay on the right side of the roadway, and be ready to stop within the distance you can see. Use low beams when visibility conditions require them.

Required California handling.

- Remove or replace the instruction to ‘keep to the left.’ For a California two-way roadway, learners must not move toward opposing traffic merely to obtain a view through parked-car gaps; stay in the appropriate right-side travel path, reduce speed, and stop if the visible space is inadequate.
- State the operative California rule explicitly: choose a speed that allows the vehicle to stop within the distance visible ahead, rather than relying only on ‘nice and easy’ or ‘not too fast.’
- Add pedestrian direction: where a pedestrian may be crossing, use caution and reduce speed or stop so the pedestrian can safely finish crossing (Handbook, ‘Pedestrians,’ p. 32).
- If adapting the item to fog, rain, snow, smoke, dust, or darkness, add the applicable low-beam-headlight rule; do not imply that the clip itself teaches it.
- Do not treat the visible dashboard reading (approximately 24–29, unit not established) as California speed guidance.

> **Traffic-side localization:** The source visual uses left-side traffic. In California, follow the stated right-side/right-edge rule. The visual is a discussion example, not a road-position model.

Knowledge check. True or False: On a narrow California two-way street with a blind bend, it is acceptable to move left toward possible oncoming traffic solely to see through gaps between parked cars.

- True
- False

Correct response: False

Why: California’ s Basic Speed Law requires a speed safe for current conditions, and the handbook directs drivers in reduced visibility to ensure they can stop within the space visible ahead. The safe response is to slow or stop while maintaining an appropriate travel path, not to move toward opposing traffic for a better view. If a pedestrian may be crossing, use caution and reduce speed or stop (Handbook, ‘Manage Your Speed’ p. 52; ‘Pedestrians’ p. 32; ‘Fog or Heavy Smoke’ p. 50).

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. At a narrow California two-way street’ s blind bend, parked cars obscure a possible pedestrian crossing. Branch A: reduce speed, remain in the appropriate right-side travel path, and proceed only when the visible path is clear and stopping space is available. Branch B: move left to look through parked-car gaps; redirect the learner to slow or stop and wait for safe visibility. Both outcomes remain non-crash, instructional outcomes.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — no Creative Commons license designation was explicitly visible in the reviewed public watch-page extract.

17. Making Space for a Trailer-Towing Vehicle Merging on a Freeway

Category: Space and Speed
Source video: Leaving Space for Larger Vehicles, Correctly
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

On a busy freeway, a driver creates room for a vehicle towing a trailer to merge. In California, leave a safe following distance, ease off the accelerator if a vehicle merges too closely, and make space for freeway traffic entering your lane.

Required California handling.

- Add California-specific instruction: if a vehicle merges too closely ahead, take your foot off the accelerator to create space, then re-establish at least a three-second following distance.
- Add that drivers should make space for vehicles entering a freeway even when they have the right-of-way; do not accelerate to close the gap or block the merge.
- Do not present the clip as proof of a measured safe gap: no following time, speed, or distance is stated or verifiable in the Short.
- Describe the shown vehicle accurately as a utility vehicle towing an enclosed trailer, not necessarily a commercial heavy vehicle or large truck.

Knowledge check. A vehicle merges into your freeway lane closer than you expected. According to the California handbook, what is the best response?

- A. Accelerate so the vehicle cannot settle into the gap.
- B. Take your foot off the accelerator to create space, then restore a safe following distance.
- C. Immediately change lanes without checking mirrors or blind spots.
- D. Follow closely so other vehicles cannot merge in front of you.

Correct response: B. Take your foot off the accelerator to create space, then restore a safe following distance.

Why: California’ s “Tailgating (Following Too Closely)” guidance says that when a vehicle merges too closely in front of you, take your foot off the accelerator to create space. The same section directs drivers to use the three-second rule; it also says to make space for vehicles entering freeways, even when the driver has the right-of-way.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Branching freeway-merge decision: a trailer-towing vehicle signals and begins moving into the learner’ s lane ahead. The learner chooses to ease off the accelerator and create a gap or to maintain/accelerate. Safe outcomes show the merge completing with space restored, a three-second following gap re-established, and continued scanning; do not depict a crash.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the consulted public YouTube watch page did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license.

18. Why More Speed Requires More Stopping Space

Category: Space and Speed
Source video: Car Stopping Distance Demonstration
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

On a dry closed course, a sedan braking at 40 and 60 km/h shows how higher speed uses more distance. California learners: treat this as a comparison, use the three-second following rule, and adjust space for conditions.

Required California handling.

- Add a California framing statement: “Use the three-second rule to maintain a safe following distance; this gives you time to react if the vehicle ahead brakes suddenly.”
- Label the demonstrated metric speeds for California learners: 40 km/h is approximately 25 mph and 60 km/h is approximately 37 mph. Do not present either as a California

speed-limit recommendation.

- State that the film compares braking outcomes on one dry, closed course only; it does not measure or establish a universal reaction, braking, or total stopping distance.
- Add that drivers should scan at least 10 seconds ahead and create more space rather than rely on hard braking when a hazard develops.

Knowledge check. What following interval does the California handbook say to use to help ensure a safe following distance and avoid a collision?

- A. One second
- B. Two seconds
- C. Three seconds
- D. Five car lengths

Correct response: C. Three seconds

Why: California DMV's Section 6, "Tailgating (Following Too Closely)" (p. 44; PDF p. 48), directs drivers to use the three-second rule because safe following space gives time to react if another driver brakes suddenly or makes a mistake.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. On a dry road, a vehicle merges closely ahead near a marked pedestrian crossing. Branches: continue tailgating, or lift off the accelerator and re-establish at least a three-second gap. Safe outcome: select the second branch; the activity explains that added space provides reaction time, with no collision depiction.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public YouTube watch page was checked solely for licensing and the retrieved page content did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license.

19. Use the California Three-Second Following-Distance Check

Category: Space and Speed
Source video: How to Measure Safe Following Distance in Timing
California determination: ALIGNED WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Choose a fixed roadside object. When the vehicle ahead lines up with it, count to three; your front bumper should reach the object after the count. California drivers should add space when conditions or hazards reduce their margin.

Required California handling.

- Revise the qualification 'at high speed in good conditions' to California framing: three seconds is the basic DMV following-distance rule; increase space whenever

conditions or hazards reduce the safety margin.

- Add California’ s specific p. 44 direction: if another vehicle merges too closely ahead, take your foot off the accelerator to create space; make additional space for a tailgater and when following motorcyclists on metal surfaces or gravel.

Knowledge check. In clear conditions, the vehicle ahead lines up with a fixed roadside sign. Under California’ s three-second rule, when should your vehicle reach that same sign?

- After counting three seconds
- As soon as the vehicle ahead reaches the sign
- After counting one second
- Only after the vehicle ahead is completely out of sight

Correct response: After counting three seconds

Why: California Quick Reference Driver’ s Handbook (2025), Section 6, ‘Tailgating (Following Too Closely),’ p. 44 directs drivers to use the three-second rule to maintain a safe following distance and provide time to react if another driver makes a mistake.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Media status: UNVERIFIED — the public YouTube watch page consulted did not explicitly display a Creative Commons license.

20. California: Drive Distraction-Free

Category: Supplemental Topic
Source video: OTS Go Safely Distracted Driving
California determination: APPROPRIATE WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

This California Office of Traffic Safety video shows how phones, navigation, food, music, and reaching for objects can divide attention. Before driving, silence and put away your phone; if something requires attention, pull safely off the road.

Required California handling.

- For an adult, use a phone hands-free only when necessary; let a call go to voicemail or pull safely off the road. Never send or read texts or emails while driving.
- For minors, explicitly teach the handbook prohibition on cell-phone/electronic-device use for calls or texts while driving, except for an emergency-assistance call.
- Do not assess the video’ s 2021 penalty statement as current law. Use the supplied handbook and current DMV material as the controlling legal source.

Knowledge check. According to the 2025 California Quick Reference Driver’ s Handbook, what should an adult driver do if a call must be returned while driving?

- A. Answer by holding the phone below the windshield.
- B. Return the call after pulling safely off the road.
- C. Send a quick text response while stopped in traffic.
- D. Program the call through the navigation screen while moving.

Correct response: B. Return the call after pulling safely off the road.

Why: The handbook says not to answer a ringing cell phone; let it go to voicemail. If a call must be returned or made, pull safely off the road. Do not send or read texts or emails while driving.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. While driving, a phone rings and a map needs rerouting. The safe decision is to leave the phone untouched, continue driving, and handle the call or route only after pulling over and parking safely.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — no Creative Commons license designation was explicitly visible; do not infer reuse rights.

21. A DUI Affects More Than the Driver

Category: Supplemental Topic
Source video: Press Conference :30 | Impaired Driving | Drive Sober or Get Pulled Over
California determination: APPROPRIATE WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

A staged press conference confronts a young driver with the personal, financial, and life-changing consequences of a DUI. For California learners: alcohol and drugs can impair you before legal limits; never drive after using either—arrange a sober ride.

Required California handling.

- Introduce the press-conference format as a dramatization of accountability, not an actual DUI procedure.
- Do not present the character’ s ten-thousand-dollar cost as a California statutory amount or guaranteed total. Teach the handbook’ s California consequences instead.
- Add the under-21 0.01% BAC rule and the handbook rule that impairment can support a DUI even below a listed BAC limit.

Knowledge check. Under the California Quick Reference Driver’ s Handbook, at what BAC is it illegal for a driver under age 21 to drive?

- A. 0.01% or higher
- B. 0.04% or higher
- C. 0.08% or higher
- D. Only when the driver feels impaired

Correct response: A. 0.01% or higher

Why: The handbook states that it is illegal for a driver under 21 to drive with a BAC of 0.01% or higher. It also explains that a BAC below a legal limit does not necessarily make driving safe.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. After a gathering, you consumed alcohol and a friend asks for a short ride home. The safe decision is not to drive; arrange a sober driver, rideshare, taxi, or other safe ride. No impairment or crash simulation is used.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — no Creative Commons license designation was explicitly visible; do not infer reuse rights.

22. California Child Passenger Safety: Seats, Belts, and the Back Seat

Category: Supplemental Topic
Source video: Child passenger safety CPS Roll Call Video 2017
California determination: APPROPRIATE WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

California roll-call training explains child restraints, booster-seat belt fit, back-seat safety, and airbag risks. Use it with the 2025 DMV handbook: child-restraint rules turn on both age and height, and current official guidance controls.

Required California handling.

- Use a current-law/handbook card before or after the video; this dated roll-call training is not the controlling legal source.
- Teach the handbook’ s age-or-height rule: a child under 8 OR under 4 ft 9 in must be secured in a child passenger restraint system in a rear seat, subject to stated limited exceptions.
- Do not reduce rear-facing requirements to age alone; follow the handbook’ s height and weight thresholds, manufacturer limits, and current official California guidance.

Knowledge check. In a normal passenger vehicle with an available rear seat, which restraint is required by the 2025 California handbook for a 7-year-old who is 4 ft 10 in tall?

- A. A properly used child passenger restraint system in the rear seat.
- B. A safety belt alone because the child is taller than 4 ft 9 in.
- C. Any seat belt in the front seat.
- D. No restraint if an adult is seated beside the child.

Correct response: A. A properly used child passenger restraint system in the rear seat.

Why: The handbook requires a child passenger restraint system in a rear seat for children who are under 8 years old OR less than 4 ft 9 in tall. Although this child exceeds 4 ft 9 in, the child is still under age 8.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. Plan a trip with an available rear seat and a passenger who is age 7 and 4 ft 10 in. Choose a properly used child passenger restraint in the rear seat rather than a safety belt alone. Do not ask learners to install a restraint while driving.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — no explicit Creative Commons license was visible; do not infer reuse rights.

23. California Railroad Crossings: Drive Safely Near Trains

Category: Supplemental Topic
Source video: Ryan's Brain - How to Drive Near Trains
California determination: APPROPRIATE WITH CALIFORNIA EDITS

Follow Ryan and Jessica as they learn to recognize railroad signs, warning lights, gates, multiple tracks, emergency information, and light rail. For California driving, always follow the DMV handbook and crossing signals; never enter unless you can completely clear the tracks.

Required California handling.

- When flashing red lights warn of a train, stop and do not proceed until the lights stop flashing—even if the gate rises. When devices or a person warn of a train, stop at least 15 feet from the nearest track.
- Add the California visibility speed rule: 15 mph within 100 feet of a crossing when tracks cannot be seen for 400 feet in both directions, unless a gate, warning signal, or flagman controls the crossing.
- Add California’ s disabled-on-tracks procedure from p. 53, including exiting and moving diagonally toward an approaching train when it is near, then calling 911.

Knowledge check. At a California railroad crossing, the red lights are flashing and the gate has begun to rise. What should you do?

- A. Proceed because the gate is rising.
- B. Stop and wait until the red lights stop flashing.
- C. Drive around the gate if no train is visible.
- D. Proceed after looking once in the direction of the last train.

Correct response: B. Stop and wait until the red lights stop flashing.

Why: California’ s handbook says flashing red warning lights require a stop and that drivers must not proceed until the red lights stop flashing, even if the gate rises.

Novato-area relevance: Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road. [California OTS, Novato 2023]

Optional QTE brief. A queue beyond the tracks is stopped, leaving insufficient space to clear the crossing. Choose Wait before the tracks; never begin crossing unless the vehicle can completely clear the tracks. No driving controls or train-beating scenario is used.

Media status: UNVERIFIED — no Creative Commons license designation was visible; do not infer reuse rights.

Recommended App Sequencing

Start with road awareness, lane changes, and space management before moving to intersection priority and emergency response. Keep the two emergency-vehicle clips adjacent, but retain the California contrast card: yielding happens at the **right edge** in California, and a driver already in an intersection first clears it before stopping. Place the freeway-ramp and merge lessons in the same module, then use the ramp-terminal local evidence to make the transition concrete without overclaiming citywide causation.

The next module should cover distraction, impairment, seat belts and child passenger safety, and railroad crossings. These additions close essential gaps in the original 19-video set. Link, rather than copy, the media. Before a launch, a content owner should recheck each live link and either obtain reuse permission or replace the video with an original, rights-cleared asset.

References

[1] California DMV Driver’ s Handbook portal
[2] California Office of Traffic Safety — Novato 2023 crash ranking profile
[3] California Office of Traffic Safety — Marin County 2023 crash ranking profile

[4] Caltrans 2024 Crash Data on California State Highways
[5] Transportation Authority of Marin — Alameda del Prado/Nave Drive interchange report
[6] UC Berkeley SafeTREC/TIMS — SWITRS overview and limitations
[7] California Highway Patrol — SWITRS database information
[8] Caltrans — SR 37 Project Background